

Partition Woes

Q I have P 4 2.6 GHz, 80 GB hard disk and 512 MB RAM and currently, there are four partitions on the hard drive. I would like to have only three; two of 30 GB and one of 20 GB. I want to keep Windows 98 SE and XP on one of the 30 GB partitions, and create a 20 GB dump. However, I have heard that you cannot increase the size of the partition that has an OS on it. How do I go about doing this?

Gacarot, Via e-mail

A First, you need to create a Windows 98 Start-up Disk. To do that, insert a freshly formatted 1.44 MB floppy disk in the floppy drive. In the Windows 98 Control Panel, double-click on 'Add-Remove Programs' and click on 'Start-up Disk' tab and then on the 'Create Disk' button. Boot using this disk and at the 'Start-up' menu, opt to boot with or without CD-ROM support.

At the command prompt, type FDISK and press 'Y' when prompted to enable support for large disk drives. Since you already have multiple partitions on your hard drive, you will need to delete them first. In the first screen, press '3' to delete partition or logical DOS drive. In the next screen, press '3' to delete the logical DOS drive in the extended DOS partition and press 'Enter'.

You will be asked "What drive do you want to delete?" Enter the drive letter and press 'Enter'. Next you have to enter the volume label, enter it and press 'Enter' and press 'Y' and 'Enter'. Press 'Esc' to return to the previous screen and delete the other two remaining partitions in the same

way. Press 'Esc' twice to return to the main FDISK menu and press '3' to delete partition or logical DOS drive and press 'Enter'. Press '2' to delete the extended DOS partition and press 'Enter'. Now press '1' to delete the primary DOS partition in a way similar to the logical drives.

After deleting all the partitions, press Escape twice to return to the main FDISK menu. Now press '1' to create a DOS partition or Logical DOS Drive and press 'Enter'. In the next screen, press '1' to create a Primary DOS partition and press 'Enter'. You will be asked if you wish to allocate the maximum available space to this partition, press 'N' and enter the size of the partition required as 30,000 MB and press 'Enter'.

You will then be returned to the previous screen where you have to press '2' to create an Extended DOS partition and press 'Enter'. Choose to use all the available disk space for this drive because this extended partition will hold all the remaining partitions that you will be creating. You will once again be returned to the previous screen and you must now press '3' to create a Logical DOS drive in the Extended DOS partition and press 'Enter'.

Choose 30,000 as the size of the partition and press 'Enter'. Thereafter, you will be asked if you wish to create a partition in the remaining space. Press 'Y' and hit 'Enter' to use all the remaining space to create the last partition. Press 'Esc' to exit FDISK and reboot your PC and after formatting, your partitions are ready to use.

It is not possible to change the partition size of a drive on which your operating system resides unless you use a partition managing utility such as Partition Magic.

A To solve your problem, download and install the latest version of the Philips PSC705 sound card drivers from www.philips.com and the latest drivers for PixelView PlayTV Pro Ultra from www.pixelview.com. Also install the latest version of your display drivers and DirectX 9.0c. Your problem will be solved and you will be able to get clear sound without disabling your TV Tuner card.

Which Motherboard Do I Have?

Q I have a Compaq Presario 5600, P 5 1.5 GHz, 128 MB SDRAM, nVidia VANTA 16 MB video card running Windows XP. However, on my motherboard, it says 'PC 133 SDRAM' only. Can I install DDR RAM on it? How can I determine which motherboard I am using? Would upgrading my SDRAM or buying a new motherboard with DDR RAM slot be beneficial? Also, I've heard that DDR RAM slots can be inserted in any motherboard. Is this true? I am an average gamer and particularly play racing games.

Prateek Rajput, Via e-mail

A The Compaq Presario 5600 supports only SDRAM and hence, you cannot install DDR RAM modules. To install DDR RAM modules, a motherboard must have DDR RAM slots. Not all motherboards are equipped with DDR RAM and hence cannot have DDR RAM. Upgrading to a new motherboard with DDR RAM would definitely benefit you due to the high memory bandwidth on these motherboards. Utilities



such as SiSoft Sandra 2005 from www.sisoftware.net and Everest 2.00 from www.lavalys.com can be used to determine the motherboard details of a PC in addition to other hardware and software details.

Removing Colour Profiles

Q When I go to shutdown the computer, a blue screen appears and displays the following message: A fatal exception OE has occurred at 0187:BFF9DFF. The current application will be terminated.

* Press [CTRL] + [ALT] + [DEL] to restart your computer. You will lose any unsaved information in all application.
Press any key to continue.

Arka Banerjee, Via e-mail

A A graphics/image program that you have installed is changing your monitor/printer ICC profiles. These are files that calibrate the colour for all the input and output devices. Find out which program is doing this and if there is an option to disable profile settings.

Alternatively, you can reset Windows to use the standard colour profiles by opening the 'Display Properties' in the 'Control Panel'. To do this, click on **Settings > Advanced > Colour Management**, where you will be able to view all colour profiles installed on your computer.

Remove all these profiles by clicking on each of them and then clicking on 'Remove'. Click on 'Apply' to apply the new settings. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details to sos@jasubhai.com, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!